BRAIN 15

P21 (P021)

Lab-made pentapeptide built from part of ciliary neurotrophic factor (CNTF), a nerve-cell protein



CLASS	STUDIED FOR	HUMAN EVIDENCE	US STATUS
Peptide	Memory, Alzheimer's models	Lab or animal only	Not FDA approved

STUDIED FOR

- **Memory** — ANIMAL
- **New nerve cells** — ANIMAL
- **Aging brain** — ANIMAL
- **Retina changes** — ANIMAL

No human studies. All published work is in mice, rats or cells, almost all from the group that developed P021.

EVIDENCE & WHAT'S KNOWN

EVIDENCE

LAB OR ANIMAL
LEVEL 1 OF 5

- Mouse, rat and cell studies only
- Almost all from the developer's group
- No human study published or registered

NOT YET ESTABLISHED

- Any effect in people
- Safety in people
- Half-life in people
- Dose in people

HOW IT WORKS IN THE BODY

P021 ▶ Enters the brain ▶ BDNF, GSK-3β ▶ New nerve cells

- **Built from CNTF,** with a group added to slow breakdown, its developers say
- **Crosses the blood–brain barrier** in aged rats
- **Higher BDNF, lower GSK-3β** reported in Alzheimer's model mice
- **In people,** the mechanism is not established

QUICK PRACTICAL INFO

HALF-LIFE
Not established in people

ROUTES STUDIED
None studied in people; in feed (by mouth) in animals

PHARMACOKINETICS
No human data

SOLD AS
"Research use only" labels; not for human use

MONITORED IN TRIALS
No human trials; memory and brain markers in animals

SPORT (WADA)
Not named on the 2026 list; S0 status not stated

REGULATORY

FDA	Not approved; no product in Drugs@FDA
HHS	Not in the Oct 2026 peptide compounding policy
DEA	Not a controlled substance
WADA	Not named on the 2026 list

REFERENCES

1. Alzheimers Res Ther, Baazaoui and Iqbal, P021 in 3xTg-AD mice, Jun 2017
2. Neurobiol Dis, Kazim et al., P021 in Alzheimer's model mice, Nov 2014
3. WADA, 2026 Prohibited List

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